

Sports Scholarship Scheme — Scheme Guidelines

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Issued in 2026 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/SCH/2026/008, this scheme guidelines establishes the arrangements supporting Sports Scholarship Scheme. In scope are Sports, Scholarship, Athletes, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Context and Background

The scheme landscape has evolved considerably in recent years, and institutions under Higher Education Department have responded with renewed attention to Sports, Scholarship, Athletes. This scheme guidelines provides the framework needed to guide consistent practice across the sector.

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Higher Education Department has prepared this scheme guidelines to give effect to Sports, Scholarship. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Purpose and Intent

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Sports, Scholarship across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

This scheme guidelines is intended to translate the objectives of Sports Scholarship Scheme into actionable direction for institutions, officials and other stakeholders, ensuring that Sports is pursued in a structured and accountable manner.

Objectives

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for Sports, Scholarship, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

The principal objectives are to strengthen Sports, harmonise institutional approaches to Scholarship, and establish measurable indicators through which progress can be tracked and reported.

Coverage

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Higher Education Department, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

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Key Provisions

Institutions are required to integrate Sports, Scholarship into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

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Implementation Arrangements

Institutions are expected to appoint a lead authority for implementation, adapt the framework to local context, and report progress to Higher Education Department in line with the prescribed cycle.

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

Roles and Responsibilities

Clear allocation of responsibility is expected at institutional level, with Higher Education Department acting as the coordinating authority for evaluation, escalation and cross-institutional learning.

Higher Education Department provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Monitoring Arrangements

Monitoring covers both compliance and quality, combining documented evidence with stakeholder feedback to build a complete picture of institutional performance over time.

Way Forward

This document is designed to evolve with institutional experience. Feedback from stakeholders will shape refinements, ensuring that the framework remains practical, proportionate and fit for purpose.